中間課題　認知バイアスと根拠に基づく意思決定

次の文章を読み、問題に答えなさい。
なお、全部で問題文は、４ページある。

（出典）Kreitner, R. and Kinicki, A. 2013. Organizational Behavior. 8th Ed. New York: McGraw-Hill Irwin, pp.337-341,

real WORLD // real PEOPLE

Overconfidence Bias Partly to Blame for Oil-Rig Disaster

According to Bob Bea, an engineering professor at the University of California Berkely, "technological disasters, like the PB oil spill, follow a well-worn "trail of tears." Bea has investigated 630 different types of disasters and is an expert on offshore drilling.

"Bea categorizes disasters into four groups. One such group is when an organization simply ignores warning signs through overconfidence and incompetence. He thinks the BP spill falls into that category. Bea pointed to congressional testimony that BP ignored problems with a dead battery, leaky cement job, and loose hydraulic fittings."

"Disasters don't happen because of 'an evil empire,' Bea said. 'It's hubris, arrogance, and indolence.'"

"Cutting-edge technology often works flawlessly. At first, everyone worries about risk. Then people get lulled into complacency by success, and they forget that they are operating on the edge, say experts who study disasters. Corners get cut, problems ignored. Then boom."

Charles Perrow, a professor at Yale University, concluded that "there's nothing safe out there. We like to pretend there is and argue afterward, 'That's why we took the risks, because it hadn't failed before.'"

How could BP have overcome the overconfidence bias?

SOURCE: Excerpted from S Borenstein, "Disasters Often Stem from Hubris," *The Arizona Republic*, July 12, 2010, p A4.



The Deep Horizon oil rig disaster.

TO THE POINT

What is thrust of evidence-based decision making, and what does it take to implement this approach in organizations?

LO.3 Evidence-Based Decision Making

Interest in the concept of evidence-based decision making stems from two sources. The first is the desire to avoid the decision-making biases discussed in the previous section, and the second is research done on evidence-based medicine. Dr David Sackett defines evidence-based medicine as "the conscientious, explicit and judicious use of current best evidence in making decisions about the care of individual patients." Researchers and practitioners are studying evidence-based medicine because research suggests that physicians make only 15% of their decisions based on evidence, and this approach helps determine the most efficient use of health care resources.[27] OB researchers have taken this framework and applied it to the context of managerial decision making.

Quite simply, **evidence-based decision making** (EBDM) represents a process of conscientiously using the best available data and evidence when making managerial decisions. We explore this new approach to decision making by beginning with a model of EBDM and then reviewing a set of implementation principles that can help companies to implement this model of decision making. We conclude by examining the reasons why it is hard to implement EBDM. Understanding this material will help you reduce the susceptibility to decision-making biases.

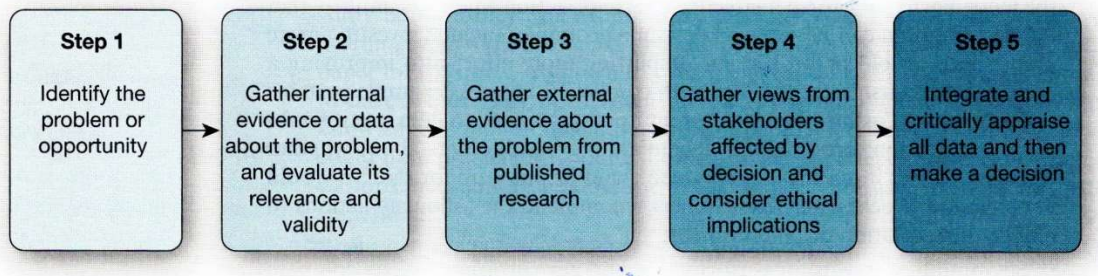
connect Go to www.mcgrawhillconnect.com for an interactive exercise to test your knowledge of evidence-based decision making.

A Model of Evidence-Based Decision Making (EBDM)

Figure 12–2 illustrates a five-step model of EBDM.[28] You can see that the process begins by gathering internal and external data and evidence about a problem at hand. This information is then integrated with views from stakeholders (e.g., employees, shareholders, customers) and ethical considerations to make a final decision. All told, the process shown in Figure 12–2 helps managers to face hard facts and avoid their personal biases when making decisions. EBDM's use of relevant and reliable data from different sources is clearly intended to make any decision-making context more explicit, critical, systematic, and fact based.

It is important to consider that evidence is used in three different ways within the process depicted in Figure 12–2: to make a decision, to inform a decision, and to support a decision.[29] "Evidence is used to *make* a decision whenever the decision follows directly from the evidence." For example, if you wanted to purchase a particular used car (e.g., Toyota Prius) based on price and color (e.g., red), you

figure 12–2 Evidence-Based Decision-Making Model



SOURCE: Derived from R B Briner, D Denyer, and D M Rousseau. "Evidence-Based Management: Concept Cleanup Time?" *Academy of Management Perspectives*, November 2009, pp 19–32.

would obtain data from the Internet and classified ads and then choose the seller offering the lowest priced red Prius. "Evidence is used to inform a decision whenever the decision process combines hard, objective facts with qualitative inputs, such as intuition or bargaining with stakeholders." For instance, in hiring new college graduates, objective data about applicants' past experience, education, and participation in student organizations would be relevant input to making a hiring decision. Nonetheless, subjective impressions garnered from interviews and references would typically be combined with the objective data to make a final decision. These two uses of evidence are clearly positive and should be encouraged. The same cannot be said about using evidence to support a decision.

"Evidence is used to *support* a decision whenever the evidence is gathered or modified for the sole purpose of lending legitimacy to a decision that has already been made." This application of evidence has both positive and negative effects. On the positive side, manufactured evidence can be used to convince an external audience that the organization is following a sound course of action in response to a complex and ambiguous decision context. This can lead to confidence and goodwill about how a company is responding to environmental events. On the negative side, this practice can stifle employee involvement and input because people will come to believe that management is going to ignore evidence and just do what it wants. There are two takeaways about using evidence to support a decision. First, this practice should not always be avoided. Second, because this practice has both pros and cons, management needs to carefully consider when it "might" be appropriate to ignore disconfirming evidence and push its own agenda or decisions.

Seven Implementation Principles

Stanford professors Jeffrey Pfeffer and Robert Sutton have been studying evidence-based management for quite some time. Based on this experience, they offer seven implementation principles to help companies integrate EBDM into an organization's culture.[30]

1. **Treat your organization as an unfinished prototype.** The thrust of this principle involves creating a mindset that the organization is an unfinished prototype that may be broken and in need of repair, thus avoiding the hubris and arrogance of concluding that nothing needs to be changed in the organization. For example, the products QVC sells are chosen through a process of experimentation in which EBDM is used to understand why some products sell and others don't. The use of experiments, as done at QVC, is one recommendation for making this happen. The Real World/Real People on page 340 illustrates how one retailer uses experimentation to determine the best type of promotions.[31]
2. **No brag, just facts.** This slogan is used by DaVita, a company that operates 600 dialysis centers, to reinforce a culture that supports EBDM. The company measures, monitors, and rewards the effectiveness of its dialysis centers



This dialysis patient is benefitting from DaVita's use of EBDM. The use of EBDM helps the company provide better service, and ultimately contributes to profitability.

evidence-based decision making
Conscientiously using the best data when making decisions.

and patient well-being on a regular basis. In contrast, Hewlett-Packard's former CEO Carly Fiorina bragged to the press about the company's merger with Compaq but failed to do any research on consumers' opinions about Compaq products prior to the merger. These products were viewed as among the worst in the industry.

3. **See yourself and your organization as outsiders do.** Many managers are filled with optimism and inflated views of their talents and chances for success. This leads them to downplay risks and to commit an escalation of commitment bias. "Having a blunt friend, mentor, or counselor," Pfeffer and Sutton suggest, "can help you see and act on better evidence."
4. **Evidence-based management is not just for senior executives.** Research shows that the best organizations are those in which all employees, not just top managers, are committed to EBDM.[32] Pfeffer and Sutton encourage managers to "treat employees as if a big part of their job is to invent, find, test, and implement the best ideas." This implies that employees must be given the training and resources needed to engage in EBDM.
5. **Like everything else, you still need to sell it.** "Unfortunately, new and exciting ideas grab attention even when they are vastly inferior to old ideas," say Pfeffer and Sutton. "Vivid, juicy stories and case studies sell better than detailed, rigorous, and admittedly dull data—no matter how wrong the stories or how right the data." This means that you will need to similarly use vivid stories and case studies such as the DaVita example used earlier to sell the value of EBDM. You can also hire gurus to help sell the value of evidence-based practices.
6. **If all else fails, slow the spread of bad practice.** Because employees may face pressures to do things that are known to be ineffective, it may be necessary to engage in what Pfeffer and Sutton call "evidence-based misbehavior." This can include ignoring requests and delaying action. Be cautious if you use this principle.
7. **The best diagnostic question: what happens when people fail?** "Failure hurts, it is embarrassing, and we would rather live without it," say the Stanford professors. "Yet there is no learning without failure. . . . If you look at how the most effective systems in the world are managed, a hallmark is that when something goes wrong, people face the hard facts, learn what happened and why, and keep using those facts to make the system better." The US civil aviation system is a good example. It has created the safest system in world through its accident and incident reporting system. Ford's CEO Alan Mulally is another example. He meets with his top 15 executives every Thursday morning at 7 A.M. for 2½ hours to conduct a business plan review. "He requires his direct reports to post more than 300 charts, each of them color-coded red, yellow, or green to indicate problems, caution, or progress. . . . Afterward, the adjoining Taurus and Continental rooms are papered with these charts so Mulally can study them. As the CEO likes to say, 'You can't manage a secret. When you do this every week, you can't hide.'"[33]

Why Is It Hard to be Evidenced Based?

Despite the known value of using EBDM, there are seven reasons why it is hard for anyone to bring the best evidence to bear when making decisions. They are: (1) There's too much evidence. (2) There's not enough good evidence. (3) The evidence doesn't quite apply. (4) People are trying to mislead you. (5) You are trying to mislead you. (6) The side effects outweigh the cure. (7) Stories are more persuasive, anyway.[34]

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